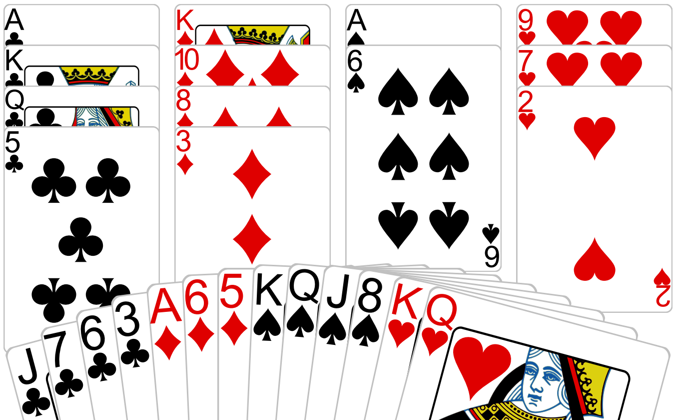
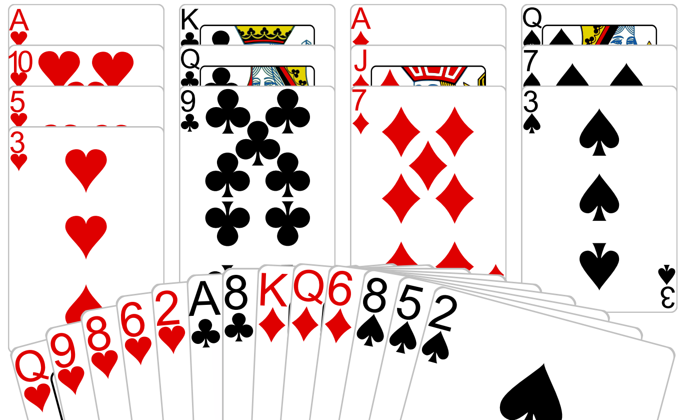
Deal 1 Ctr: **6NT** Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners			
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Deal 3 Ctr: **4♥** Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Board: 1 Dealer: **North** Contract: 6NT Declarer: North

Board: 3 Dealer: **West** Contract: 4♥ Declarer: East

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	North	
	♠ K Q J 8 ♥ K Q ♦ A 6 5 ♣ J 7 6 3	
West ♠ 10 7 4 2 ♥ A 5 4 3 ♦ J 4 ♣ 10 8 2	N W E S	**East** ♠ 9 5 3 ♥ J 10 8 6 ♦ Q 9 7 2 ♣ 9 4
	♠ A 6 ♥ 9 7 2 ♦ K 10 8 3 ♣ A K Q 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	4NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by North

Partner's 4NT bid is not Blackwood, it is the Quantitative 4NT. He is unsure whether to bid 6NT or not, so is inviting you to do so.

With 15 points you are supposed to pass. With 17 points you are supposed to bid 6NT. Wouldn't you know it, 16 points. Today you feel bold, so you say 6NT.

North plays 6NT. East leads the ♥J.

West plays the ♥A and returns the ♥3.

Winner List: ♠ = 4 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 4 :: Total = 11

One trick is already lost and at first glance it looks like your only slim chance will be for the ♦ Q J to fall doubleton.

But a dummy has a very important card, the ♥9. You know from the opening lead that East holds the ♥10, so if he happens to hold the only guard in ♦s you will be able to squeeze him in the red suits.

You don't even have to do anything special. Play your 4 ♣ winners, then 3 ♠ winners.

Now play the ♠J and watch East's discard. If he throws the ♥10 dummy's ♥9 will become a winner. If he doesn't throw the ♥10 then you know dummy's ♥9 is worthless so discard it and hope the ♦s are good.

Squeeze plays can be complex to figure out and difficult to execute.

But not always. Sometimes they just happen, like this one. You were really hoping for the ♦Q and ♦J to fall and you fell into the squeeze instead.

Board 3
West Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ A K J 9 6 4 ♥ J ♦ 10 5 3 ♣ J 7 4	
♠ Q 7 3 ♥ A 10 5 3 ♦ A J 7 ♣ K Q 9	N W E S	♠ 8 5 2 ♥ Q 9 8 6 2 ♦ K Q 6 ♣ A 8
	♠ 10 ♥ K 7 4 ♦ 9 8 4 2 ♣ 10 6 5 3 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	2♠	3♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			

4♥ by East

When partner opens 1NT, interference can easily gum up your smooth bidding sequences. Playing the lebensohl convention, your 3♥ bid shows a 5-card suit and is forcing to game.

It doesn't always work out so well, but here partner had an easy 4♥ bid.

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♠10.

Whatever you play, North takes the ♠ A K J and then plays a small ♣. South started with just one ♠.

Loser List: ♠ = 3 : ♥ = ? : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = ?

Don't let that Question Mark by the ♥ losers mislead you - if you are going to make this contract you cannot lose a ♥ trick at all! Is there any hope?

The odds aren't good, but you actually have **TWO** possibilities for success. If South holds the singleton ♥K, you can play a small ♥ to dummy's ♥A, dropping the ♥K, then finesse North out of his ♥J. Or, if North holds the singleton ♥J you can play your ♥Q, finessing South for the ♥K and at the same time smothering North's ♥J.

Which basket will you put your eggs into?

The answer is simple Bridge math! North started with 6 ♠s leaving him 7 cards outside the ♠ suit. South started with just 1 ♠, leaving him with 12 cards outside the ♠ suit. Obviously North is much more likely to have a singleton ♥ than South.

So you win the ♣A in your hand, play the ♥Q and let it ride if South does not cover.

Then you

Ahh, success.

But to tell the truth, the Bridge math wasn't really complete. Distribution-wise it was just fine, but there is also the question of strength.

The fact that North overcalled makes it more likely that he holds more high cards than South, and this skews the odds toward North holding the ♥K.

But think about it. If North does in fact hold the singleton ♥K, and if you cleverly drop it by playing dummy's ♥A it won't help you. You will then have to lose a trick to South's ♥J.